

Post-incident review PIR-2025-027

Order Management: partial outage

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 13 June 2025, Order Management experienced partial outage in production (AU Southeast) for about 160 minutes. Staff in the contact centre noticed the console was slow and told the service owner. Investigation found that the autoscaler reached its maximum instance count during a traffic peak.

Impact

Users of Order Management saw partial outage for about 160 minutes. The service owner, Commerce Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:20 First signal received.
- 09:36 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:49 Likely cause identified.
- 10:19 Mitigation applied.
- 10:34 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the autoscaler reached its maximum instance count during a traffic peak.

Customer impact was limited because most traffic was served from cache.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.
- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.